



NCD SMALL CRAFT REGISTRATION BOARD

ADMINISTRATION OFFICE | LEVEL 1 | CITY HALL
ANNEX BUILDING | WAIGANI, NATIONAL CAPITAL
DISTRICT.

P O BOX 1392, PORT MORESBY, NATIONAL CAPITAL
DISTRICT



Hon Powes parkop, MP, LLB, LLM
Governor of the National Capital District
Chairman of the National Capital District Commission
Level 4, City Hall Annex building
City Hall, WAIGANI

14 December, 2021

My Dear Governor

**SUBJECT: NCD SMALL CRAFT REGISTRATION BOARD 2022
OPERATIONAL BUDGET REQUEST**

I write to you regarding the above matter.

The National Capital District Small Craft Registration Board (**NCD SCRB**) would like to formally present to you it's Budget Proposal for our 2022 Operations and Expenditures.

Preliminary

The National Capital District Small Craft Registration Board (NCD SCRB) is a legal authority set up by the municipal government of National Capital District (NCD) pursuant to the *Small Craft Act 2011* (SCA) for purposes of administering and regulating the functions under the *Small Craft Act 2011*.

The NCD SCRB is Chaired by Mr Ryan Pini and Mr Hitolo Garia as the NCD SCRB Registrar. Currently the NCD SCRB is yet to formally establish itself as an organization or authority so to carry out its functions under the *Small Craft Act*. In the interim, the National Maritime Safety Authority (NMSA) has come on board to facilitate the appointment and training for the NCD SCRB small craft inspectors which was held at the Gateway Hotel from the 23 – 25 of November 2021.

We hope now to secure funding to formally establish for our 2022 Operations and Expenditures. We understand that NCDCC has a lot to cater for the greater city of Port Moresby and kindly request that we also be included in its line of funding and assistance. We greatly



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apologies if this would cause inconvenience to your 2022 Budget plan and expenditure, however as NCD is also a maritime province, by law it is imperative that a small craft board be established in the capital city.

In saying so, we would like to give a brief summary of the progress we have had so far and also highlight the key areas where we need funding and assistance from.

Summary of Progress

The NCD SCRB has come a long way since its endorsement by the Board of the National Capital District Commission in 2020.

We are proud to advise that since that Board meeting, we have been able to successfully have 3 meetings of the Small Craft Board. We have also recruited a Small Craft Registrar, Mr. Hitolo Garia, who has taken the lead in daily operational matters of the Board.

We have also successfully interfaced with the National Maritime Safety Authority and through that relationship we have been able to successfully complete a 3-day intensive training for Small Craft Inspectors. We now have a pool of 21 fully certified candidates for employment as Small Craft Inspectors in the NCD. However, we will start with 12 and then build on from there as we progress. Also we bear in mind the funding sources and availability.

At the moment, there have been various dialogues between the NCD SCRB Chairman and various organizations and partners, including the NCDC, regarding assistance in areas of our operations.

Our Budget Proposal for 2022

For the year 2022, the NCD Small Craft Registration Board would like to begin substantive operations, with the aim of registering every dinghy or other applicable small craft, as well as outboard motor into our databases, and to begin rolling out Safety Of Life At Sea (**SOLAS**) programs to coastal communities in the NCD Maritime communities.



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To effectively perform its functions, the NCD SCRB submits it's Budget Summary as follows:

Item	Amount
Administrative Expenses	150,500.00
Operational Costs	232,800.00
Wages	298,920.00
Total	682,220.00

1. Administration Expenses

The administrative budget component consists mainly of administrative expenses required for the administrative functions of the NCD SCRB such as, office set up, Insurance, office supplies and equipment's, communications, amenities etc... It is important we have consistent budgetary lines for smooth operations administratively.

2. Operational Expenses

Operational Expenses consist of the estimated costs required for the effective running and operation of the NCD SCRB in 2022. This budget component forms the second most important feature of our budget plan and is crucial for the sustainability of the NCD SCRB in carrying out its required functions under the *Small Craft Act* 2011 and other related legislations.

Given the Metropolitan status of NCD being the Nation's Capital City, the NCD SCRB proposes for further in-depth training or courses for its Inspectors to equip and update them with the knowledge and capacity essential to carry out its functions in such setting. There is also a great need for awareness's to be carried out in all shore line areas and villages in NCD so that all the people and communities that will be affected are well informed about the NCD SCRB functions and its powers.

The other focus area under this concerns the actual operation involving the registration and inspection of all small crafts in NCD. This will be the core function of



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the NCD SCRB and its effective enforcement will also ensure the NCD SCRB generates its own revenue to be self-sustaining in the long run of its operations.

3. Wages

The *Small Craft Act* does not state with certainty from which source shall funding for the wages of the staffs of the NCD SCRB shall be sought from. Section 4(3) only provides for the terms and conditions of members of Registration Boards are to be determined by the relevant Provincial Executive Council (in this case, NCDC), however, there are no such similar provisions for the small craft inspectors nor other staffs employed by the NCD SCRB.

Thus, in reading the *Small Craft Act* as a whole it is clear that the NCD SCRB will be subjected to NCDC. Section 3(1) gives mandate to NCDC to establish a small craft board for NCD and in that regard we submit that NCDC make provisions to cater for wages of the staffs of NCD SCRB.

Submission

The NCD SCRB is eager to roll out the SCAIP (Small Craft Act Implementation Programs) in NCD and its surrounding shoreline areas or communities. It is our hope that we commence the implementation programs such as (SOLAS) Awareness programs as early as January 2022. The reports of missing small crafts (Dinghy's) and incidents involving small crafts from the members of the shoreline communities/villagers such as Hanuabada and Elevala is alarming and sad as there is no regulatory body established at the provincial government level to manage and regulate the usage of small crafts and related sea vessels.

Now that we are set up and established, it is our hope that our submission be treated as essential and important as the shoreline areas and sea areas of NCD have now seen an increase in many different activities involving all forms of small crafts and vessels, thus it is time the NCD SCRB be established and funded to fully regulate this area of importance.



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With the constant support and guidance of NMSA, we trust that funding assistance from NCDC will enable the NCD SCRB to fulfill the purposes of the *Small Craft Act* and in all, shall aim to save lives at sea.

Conclusion

The *Small Craft Act* concerns and is declared to be a matter of national interest and dealing with a matter of national importance. Any functions perform pursuant to the Act therefore binds the State pursuant to Section 1(4). Just like any Government institution or organization, the NCD SCRB is a creature of an Act of Parliament and is a Government authority. We now kindly submit to you as Governor and Chairman of the NCDC Board our 2022 Operational Budget Expenditure for funding and assistance.

Recently NCD sea areas have experienced a rise in many illegal activities and mishaps involving small crafts because of no regulatory body in place to regulate this area until now, with the full establishment of the NCD SCRB we will ensure to enforce and apply the provisions of the Act so that we prevent unfortunate incidences at sea involving small crafts from happening and also ensure safety and security of our provincial and territorial borders.

Find attached to this our **Estimated 2022 Budgetary Plan and Structure** for your consideration and determination.

The NCD SCRB thanks you and the NCDC for establishing this Authority and we look forward to working together with NCDC for a safer and secure seas in NCD.

Yours Sincerely

Ryan Pini, OL, MBE

Chairman, NCD Small Craft Registration Board



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Cc: Hon. Dadi Toka, MBE

Deputy Governor, NCD

Chairman, Motu Koita Assembly

Cc: Mr. Bernard Kipit

NCD City Manager